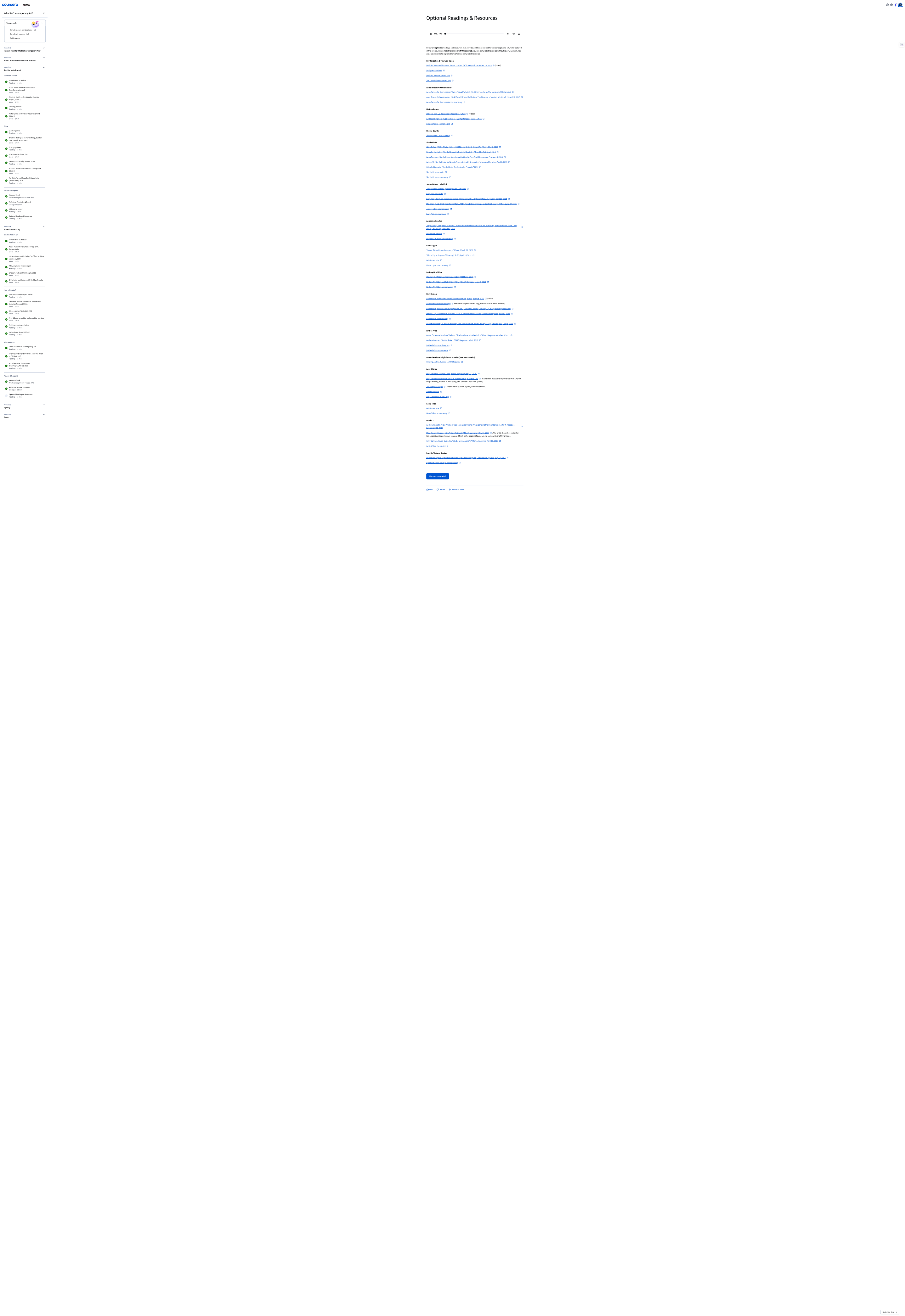

What Is Contemporary Art?

Today's goals
Complete any 3 learning items - 3/3
Complete 3 readings - 3/3
Watch a video

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Borders & Transit
- Introduction to Module 3
  Reading • 10 min
- In the studio with Rael San Fratello | Transforming the wall
  Video • 5 min
- Bouchra Khalili on The Mapping Journey Project, 2008–11
  Video • 3 min
- Crossing borders
  Reading • 10 min
- Mateo López on Travel without Movement, 2008–10
  Video • 2 min

Place
- Claiming space
  Reading • 10 min
- Shellyne Rodriguez on Martin Wong, Stanton near Forsyth Street, 1983
  Video • 1 min
- Changing states
  Reading • 10 min
- IRWIN on NSK Garda, 2002
  Video • 1 min
- Sky Hopinka on Jáaji Approx., 2015
  Reading • 10 min
- Amanda Williams on Color(ed) Theory Suite, 2014–16
  Video • 2 min
- Portfolio: Teresa Margolles, Pista de baile (Dance Floor), 2016
  Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 90%
- Reflect on Territories & Transit
  Dialogue • 15 min
- Mid-course survey
  Reading • 5 min
- Optional Readings & Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4
Materials & Making

What Is It Made Of?
- Introduction to Module 4
  Reading • 10 min
- At the Museum with Sheila Hicks | Form, Texture, Color
  Video • 4 min
- Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- Film, vinyl, and ultrasonic gel
  Reading • 10 min
- Sheela Gowda on Of All People, 2011
  Video • 3 min
- 3-D printed architecture with Rael San Fratello
  Video • 4 min

How Is It Made?
- How is contemporary art made?
  Reading • 10 min
- Lady Pink on Trust visions that don't feature buckets of blood, 1983–84
  Video • 2 min
- Glenn Ligon on White #19, 1994
  Video • 1 min
- Amy Sillman on making and unmaking painting
  Video • 1 min
- Building, painting, printing
  Reading • 10 min
- Luther Price, Sorry, 2005–12
  Reading • 10 min

Who Makes It?
- Labor and work in contemporary art
  Reading • 10 min
- Interview with Revital Cohen & Tuur Van Balen on 75 Watt, 2013
  Reading • 10 min
- Anne Teresa De Keersmaeker, Work/Travail/Arbeid, 2017
  Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%
- Reflect on Module 4 Insights
  Dialogue • 15 min
- **Optional Readings & Resources**
  Reading • 10 min

Module 5
Agency

Module 6
Power

Optional Readings & Resources

0:05 / 4:42 1x

Below are **optional** readings and resources that provide additional content for the concepts and artworks featured in the course. Please note that these are **NOT required**; you can complete the course without reviewing them. You are also welcome to explore them after you complete the course.

Revital Cohen & Tuur Van Balen

Revital Cohen and Tuur Van Balen, 75 Watt, FACTLiverpool, December 18, 2013 (video)

Designers' website

Revital Cohen on moma.org

Tuur Van Balen on moma.org

Anne Teresa De Keersmaeker

Anne Teresa De Keersmaeker, "Work/Travail/Arbeid," Exhibition brochure, The Museum of Modern Art

Anne Teresa De Keersmaeker: Work/Travail/Arbeid, Exhibition, The Museum of Modern Art, March 29–April 2, 2017

Anne Teresa De Keersmaeker on moma.org

Liz Deschenes

In Focus with Liz Deschenes, December 7, 2020 (video)

Kathleen Peterson, "Liz Deschenes," BOMB Magazine, April 1, 2012

Liz Deschenes on moma.org

Sheela Gowda

Sheela Gowda on moma.org

Sheila Hicks

Alina Cohen, "At 84, Sheila Hicks Is Still Making Defiant, Honest Art," Artsy, May 2, 2019

Danielle Mysliwiec, "Sheila Hicks with Danielle Mysliwiec," Brooklyn Rail, April 2014

Anna Sansom, "Sheila Hicks: American with Wool in Paris," Art Newspaper, February 5, 2018

Anicka Yi, "Sheila Hicks: My Work is Associated with Sensuality," Interview Magazine, April 2, 2018

Cristobal Zanartu, "Sheila Hicks: The Sunbrella Projects," 2014

Sheila Hick's website

Sheila Hicks on moma.org

Jenny Holzer, Lady Pink

Jenny Holzer website, paintings with Lady Pink

Lady Pink's website

Lady Pink, DaeQuan Alexander Collier, "24 Hours with Lady Pink," MoMA Magazine, April 28, 2025

Min Chen, "Lady Pink Transforms MoMA PS1's Facade Into a Tribute to Graffiti History," ArtNet, June 24, 2025

Jenny Holzer on moma.org

Lady Pink on moma.org

Anupama Kundoo

Jorge Gerini, "Anupama Kundoo: 'Current Methods of Construction are Producing More Problems Than They Solve'," Arch Daily, October 7, 2017

Architect's website

Anupama Kundoo on moma.org

Glenn Ligon

"Inside Glenn Ligon's Language," MoMA, March 30, 2026

"Glenn Ligon: Layers of Meaning," Art21, April 18, 2014

Artist's website

Glenn Ligon on moma.org

Rodney McMillian

"Rodney McMillian on home and history," SFMoMA, 2019

Rodney McMillian and Seth Price, "Vinyl," MoMA Magazine, June 5, 2019

Rodney McMillian on moma.org

Neri Oxman

Neri Oxman and Paola Antonelli in conversation, MoMA, May 14, 2020 (video)

Neri Oxman: Material Ecology exhibition page on moma.org (features audio, video and text)

Neri Oxman, *Broken Nature* Symposium no.2, Triennale Milano, January 14, 2019, [Starting at 4:03:58]

Wanda Lau, "Neri Oxman 3D Prints Glass at an Architectural Scale," Architect Magazine, May 19, 2017

Neri Oxman on moma.org

Anna Burckhardt, "A New Materiality: Neri Oxman's Craft for the Biological Age," MoMA post, July 1, 2020

Luther Price

Aaron Cutler and Mariana Shellard, "The hand made Luther Price," Idiom Magazine, October 5, 2012

Andrew Lampert, "Luther Price," BOMB Magazine, July 1, 2012

Luther Price on whitney.org

Luther Price on moma.org

Ronald Rael and Virginia San Fratello (Rael San Fratello)

Printing Architecture on MoMA Magazine

Amy Sillman

Amy Sillman's "Shapes" zine, MoMA Magazine, May 13, 2020.

Amy Sillman in conversation with MoMA curator, Michelle Kuo, as they talk about the importance of shape, the shape-making outliers of art history, and Sillman's new zine. (video)

The Shape of Shape, an exhibition curated by Amy Sillman at MoMA.

Artist's website

Amy Sillman on moma.org

Kerry Tribe

Artist's website

Kerry Tribe on moma.org

Anicka Yi

Andrew Russeth, "How Anicka Yi's Science Experiments Are Expanding the Boundaries of Art," W Magazine, September 10, 2018

Mina Stone, "Cooking with Artists: Anicka Yi," MoMA Magazine, May 13, 2020. The artist shares her recipe for lemon pasta with parmesan, peas, and fresh herbs as part of our ongoing series with chef Mina Stone.

Kelly Cannon, Isabel Custodio, "Studio Visit: Anicka Yi," MoMA Magazine, April 11, 2019

Anicka Yi on moma.org

Lynette Yiadom-Boakye

Antwaun Sargent, "Lynette Yiadom-Boakye's Fictive Figures," Interview Magazine, May 15, 2017

Lynette Yiadom-Boakye on moma.org